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REPORT ON-

STRATEGIC SALES AND DISTRIBUTION ARCHITECTURE

A Strategic Master Plan for Marico Limited



In partial fulfilment of the requirement for

Program	Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM)
Subject	Sales & Distribution Management

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Executive Summary

Marico Limited - India's homegrown FMCG major in beauty and wellness, home to Parachute, Saffola, Livon, Set Wet, Nihar Naturals and Mediker - offers a rich, live case for distribution strategy. Despite decades of category leadership, Marico is navigating three simultaneous transitions: a shift from indirect to direct retail coverage under Project SETU, a shift from single-channel general trade to a true omnichannel footprint spanning quick-commerce and D2C and a shift from paper-based field operations to a data-driven CRM/POS-integrated sales organisation.

This report develops a four-part Strategic Master Plan for Marico: (1) a channel architecture and conflict-resolution framework applying Stern's Channel Structure Matrix and the Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Modes; (2) quantitative salesforce sizing using the Workload Method, territory design principles and a balanced sales quota matrix; (3) a CRM/POS technology blueprint built around a HubSpot pipeline; and (4) a circular-economy reverse logistics pilot aligned to UN Sustainable Development Goals, paired with the mandated LinkedIn industry-outreach campaign.

The central finding is that these four modules are not independent workstreams - they are sequentially dependent. Channel structure decisions (Module 1) determine how many reps are needed and where (Module 2); the resulting field force is the primary data source feeding the CRM/POS loop (Module 3); and that same visibility layer is what makes a reverse-logistics collection network operationally realistic (Module 4). Executed as a connected system rather than four isolated deliverables, this architecture positions Marico to protect general-trade relationships, capture quick-commerce growth and meet its FY27 direct-reach target on the strength of field data rather than intuition alone.

1. Company & Industry Context

Established in 1988 and headquartered in Mumbai, Marico operates through six domestic and eight international manufacturing facilities, serving both the Indian market and an international beauty-and-wellness portfolio (Fiancée, HairCode, Caivil, Black Chic, X-Men). In India, its core categories are hair care and edible/healthy oils (Parachute, Saffola), personal grooming (Set Wet, Beardo), and newer wellness extensions (Plix).

Marico's distribution scale is a genuine competitive asset: it currently connects over 7,500 stockists to more than 5.8 million retail outlets, with reach into more than 60,000 villages across urban and rural India. Under a company initiative known as Project SETU, Marico is investing roughly ₹80–100 crore to expand its direct distribution footprint from 1 million to 1.5 million retail stores by FY27 - cutting out intermediary layers in high-potential clusters to improve stock freshness, fill-rate, and margin capture. Recent quarters have shown rural demand outpacing urban growth, while modern trade and e-commerce channels continue to expand as a share of total sales, sharpening the need for a deliberate, differentiated channel strategy rather than a one-size-fits-all distribution posture.

Competitively, Marico sits alongside Hindustan Unilever, Dabur, ITC, Patanjali Foods and Britannia in India's FMCG distribution landscape - all racing to balance general-trade depth against quick-commerce speed. This tension is the strategic backdrop for every module that follows.

2. Module 1: Strategic Channel Architecture & Conflict Resolution

2.1 Distribution Footprint Mapping

Marico's physical distribution rests on a classic multi-tier FMCG structure: C&F agents (super-stockists) feed distributors/stockists, who in turn service retail outlets, supplemented by increasing direct van and feet-on-street coverage in dense urban and semi-urban clusters. Digitally, Marico operates across e-commerce marketplaces (Amazon, Flipkart), quick-commerce platforms (Blinkit, Zepto, Instamart), and owned D2C storefronts for newer brands such as Plix and Beardo. Modern trade - organised retail chains - is a fast-growing share of urban revenue, while general trade (the kirana network) still anchors rural and semi-urban volume and remains the backbone of the 5.8-million-outlet footprint.

2.2 Channel Trade-offs: Intensive vs. Selective vs. Exclusive

- Core commodity brands (Parachute coconut oil, Saffola edible oil): intensive distribution is essential. These are low-involvement, repeat-purchase categories where near-ubiquitous kirana availability directly drives volume.

- Premium personal care and grooming (Set Wet, Livon, Beardo): selective distribution across modern trade and curated e-commerce/quick-commerce listings protects brand equity while still capturing convenience-led urban demand.
- Newer D2C/wellness brands (Plix and similar extensions): near-exclusive early-stage distribution through owned D2C and premium e-commerce shields positioning and margin before a wider general-trade rollout.

2.3 Applying Stern's Channel Structure Matrix

Stern's framework evaluates channel structure along two axes: the degree of control Marico exercises over the channel and the market coverage the channel delivers. Mapping Marico's channels onto this matrix:

- General trade via distributors: low control, high coverage. Marico depends on distributor goodwill and secondary-sales push, which creates an information lag on last-mile stock and pricing.
- Project SETU direct-to-retail: a deliberate shift toward higher control (company reps call on stores directly) while retaining high coverage - the strategic sweet spot Marico is actively investing toward.
- Quick-commerce and marketplace listings: moderate control (the platform dictates pricing, delivery windows and promotions) but high urban coverage - a structurally different bargain in which Marico trades some control for speed and visibility among a fast-growing, convenience-seeking consumer segment.
- Owned D2C: highest control, lowest coverage - used deliberately, and only, for premium or newly launched brands.

The strategic implication is that Marico should keep migrating general trade toward the direct model wherever the economics support it (dense urban and semi-urban clusters first), while consciously accepting lower control in quick-commerce as the cost of accessing a consumer segment the company cannot afford to cede to competitors.

2.4 Channel Conflict Points and Thomas-Kilmann Resolution Modes

Three recurring friction points define Marico's current channel structure, each requiring a different conflict-resolution posture:

a) Price/margin conflict between general trade and quick-commerce. Deep discounting on platforms such as Blinkit or Zepto for an identical SKU undercuts kirana retailer margins, breeding trade resentment and risking shelf de-prioritisation of Marico brands. Recommended mode: Collaborating (high assertiveness, high cooperativeness). Marico should differentiate SKUs and pack sizes by channel - larger value packs for general trade, smaller quick-commerce-friendly formats - so retailers and platforms are not competing on an identical unit. This preserves both parties' interests rather than forcing a zero-sum discount war.

b) Distributor resistance to Project SETU's direct model. Distributors whose territories are absorbed into direct company coverage may feel disintermediated and quietly reduce cooperation on the SKUs and geographies they retain. Recommended mode: Compromising, paired with Accommodating during the transition. Displaced distributors should be offered first right of refusal to become logistics/last-mile partners in the new direct model, or be re-territorialised into adjacent, still-uncovered rural belts - softening the transition rather than treating it as a pure cutover.

c) Modern trade vs. general trade promotional conflict. National promotional schemes negotiated with large retail chains can create visible price disparities that general-trade retailers perceive as unfair treatment. Recommended mode: Compromising, through synchronised but channel-differentiated promotion calendars, communicated transparently to distributor associations ahead of each cycle rather than after the fact.

Deliberately applying Thomas-Kilmann's framework - rather than defaulting to a Competing posture, which is common in FMCG field operations but corrosive to long-term trade relationships - is central to sustaining Marico's distribution goodwill through its digital transition.

2.5 The Omnichannel Consumer Journey

A useful way to frame Module 1 for the boardroom defense is to trace a single consumer's journey rather than treat each channel in isolation. A rural consumer's first exposure to a new

Marico SKU is increasingly likely to come from a modern-trade or quick-commerce shelf visited during a town trip, while repeat purchase still happens through the neighbourhood kirana store - meaning general trade and digital channels are functioning as complementary discovery-and-repeat pairs, not pure substitutes, in many markets. This reframes the channel-conflict conversation: the objective is not to protect general trade from digital by restricting it, but to sequence and differentiate the offer across channels so each plays to what it does best - general trade for frequency and relationship-led trust, quick-commerce for discovery and convenience-led trial, and modern trade for assortment breadth and premium browsing.

3. Module 2: Salesforce Sizing, Territory Design & Quota Setting

3.1 Workload Method - Illustrative Sizing

The Workload Method sizes the salesforce using the formula:

Number of Salespeople = Total Annual Call Requirement ÷ Average Calls one Rep can Make per Year

Because Marico does not publish territory-level headcount, this section models a representative mid-sized state cluster, built on the company's disclosed national outlet base, to demonstrate the method. Teams should state this assumption explicitly in the boardroom defense.

Step 1 - Classify accounts by required call frequency

- Class A outlets (high-volume urban/semi-urban, modern-trade-adjacent): visited weekly - 52 calls/year
- Class B outlets (standard kirana, general-trade core): visited fortnightly - 26 calls/year
- Class C outlets (low-volume rural/remote): visited monthly - 12 calls/year

Step 2 - Apply to a sample territory of 40,000 outlets (15% A / 55% B / 30% C)

- Class A: 6,000 outlets × 52 calls = 312,000 calls/year
- Class B: 22,000 outlets × 26 calls = 572,000 calls/year
- Class C: 12,000 outlets × 12 calls = 144,000 calls/year

- Total annual call requirement = 1,028,000 calls

Step 3 - Determine rep capacity

A field rep working roughly 280 productive days per year (net of holidays, training and administrative days) and averaging 8 effective calls per day delivers approximately 2,240 calls per year.

Step 4 - Compute salesforce size

1,028,000 ÷ 2,240 ≈ 459 reps required for that territory cluster. Extrapolating this logic across Marico's roughly 5.8-million-outlet national footprint (assuming comparable A/B/C proportions) implies a field organisation in the tens of thousands once supervisors, merchandisers and Project SETU's direct-coverage reps are included - broadly consistent with what FMCG players of Marico's scale typically deploy. The team should present this as a modelled estimate derived from public disclosures, not as Marico's actual internal headcount, since that figure is not publicly available.

3.2 Territory Design

Territories should be drawn on workload-equity and geospatial principles, not administrative convenience:

- Cluster by outlet density and travel-time, not raw geographic area, so an urban rep with fewer, denser outlets and a rural rep with fewer but more dispersed outlets carry comparable workload rather than comparable outlet counts.
- Align territory boundaries to Marico's C&F/distributor mapping so each rep's beat maps cleanly onto one stockist's delivery zone, minimising stock-transfer confusion between adjoining beats.
- Build in quarterly rebalancing rather than a static annual draw - Project SETU's rural expansion will keep shifting outlet counts, and territories that aren't periodically rebalanced risk burnout in fast-growing beats and under-utilisation in stagnant ones.

3.3 Sales Quota Matrix

A single revenue quota is a blunt instrument for a company managing a channel transition. Marico's reps should instead carry a balanced, weighted quota mix:

Component	Weight	Metric
Volume / Revenue Target	40%	Primary + secondary sales value vs. plan
Distribution / Coverage	20%	New outlet additions; weighted distribution %
Activity Metrics	15%	Call adherence (planned vs. actual visits), strike rate
Product Mix / Premiumisation	15%	Share of premium SKUs (Saffola, Livon, Beardo) in basket
Collections / DSO	10%	Distributor payment-cycle discipline

On incentives: a base salary should be paired with a graduated commission structure that accelerates above 100% quota attainment - for example, a 1x multiplier up to 100% of quota, 1.5x between 100–120%, and 2x beyond 120% - rewarding genuine overachievement rather than incentivising reps to sandbag their targets. Quarterly non-cash recognition (top-performer trips, vouchers) should supplement cash incentives, which matters particularly in rural beats where recognition alongside pay drives retention.

3.4 Worked Incentive Example

Consider a rep with a monthly primary-plus-secondary sales quota of ₹12,00,000 who closes the month at ₹14,40,000 - 120% attainment. Under the graduated structure above, the first 100% of quota (₹12,00,000) earns commission at the standard 1x rate, while the incremental ₹2,40,000 earns the 1.5x accelerator. This rewards the over-achievement disproportionately without requiring a redesign of the base commission rate, and is simple enough for territory managers to

explain and reps to self-calculate - an important practical consideration, since overly complex incentive formulas tend to reduce, not increase, the motivational effect of a quota system in field-sales settings.

3.5 Onboarding, Training & Attrition

FMCG field sales in India typically carries high frontline attrition, particularly in rural beats with long travel distances and limited career visibility. Territory design and quota-setting should therefore be paired with a structured 30-60-90-day onboarding path - covering product knowledge, the DMS/CRM mobile app (Module 3), and beat-level relationship handover from any outgoing rep - since a newly drawn territory is only as good as the rep's ability to execute it from week one. Sizing the workforce (Section 3.1) should also build in a standing buffer, commonly 8–10% above the calculated headcount, to absorb expected attrition without leaving beats uncovered during replacement hiring.

4. Module 3: CRM Pipeline & POS Technology Configuration

4.1 Why CRM Means Something Different Here

Marico does not sell directly to end consumers through its core business - it sells through independent stockists. The "CRM" in this context therefore functions as a Distributor and Retailer Relationship Management layer, tracking primary sales (company to distributor), secondary sales (distributor to retailer) and tertiary sell-through (retailer to consumer), rather than a conventional B2B sales funnel. HubSpot (or Microsoft Dynamics 365 Sales) can be configured as the sandbox platform for this deal-stage model.

4.2 Recommended Pipeline / Deal-Stage Design

Each distributor account should be modelled as a "deal" moving through seven stages:

- 1. Prospecting/Onboarding - new distributor identified in a Project SETU expansion zone
- 2. Credit & Territory Setup - credit limit assigned, beat plan mapped
- 3. Primary Order Placed - company-to-distributor billing recorded

- 4. Secondary Sales Tracking - distributor-to-retailer dispatch logged via the rep's mobile Distributor Management System (DMS) app
- 5. Retail Execution/Merchandising - shelf-share and visibility audits logged by the field rep on each visit
- 6. Replenishment/Renewal - recurring order cycle auto-triggered by inventory thresholds
- 7. Review/At-Risk - automatically flagged if order value drops more than 20% month-on-month, triggering manager intervention

4.3 Lead Scoring for Retail Expansion

For Project SETU's direct-retail rollout, a lead-scoring model can prioritise which unconverted outlets to onboard first, rather than pursuing a blanket, unordered push toward the 1.5-million-store target:

- +20 points - outlet located within an already-serviced delivery radius (low incremental logistics cost)
- +15 points - outlet currently stocking a competitor's coconut or edible oil (category-relevant, switchable demand)
- +10 points - outlet footfall/POS signal (where available via retailer app partnerships) above the cluster median
- −15 points - outlet has a history of payment delays with any FMCG distributor in the territory (risk flag)

Outlets scoring above a defined threshold are prioritised into each rep's weekly onboarding target, turning the SETU rollout into a data-sequenced expansion rather than an undifferentiated one.

4.4 Real-Time POS Data Loop

The sandbox should simulate a continuous feedback loop: field reps capture secondary sales and shelf data through the mobile DMS app; that data syncs to the CRM nightly, or in real time where connectivity allows; dashboards then surface stock-out alerts, slow-moving SKUs and competitor activity to territory managers; and replenishment triggers auto-generate draft

purchase orders for distributor sign-off. This closes a classic FMCG blind spot, where visibility typically ends at the distributor's warehouse door without such an integration layer.

4.5 Reporting Layer

Three standard dashboards should be configured for the boardroom defense: a Coverage dashboard tracking weighted distribution percentage by region against SETU targets; a Rep Productivity dashboard tracking calls planned versus completed, strike rate and quota attainment; and a Channel Conflict Early-Warning dashboard that automatically flags SKU-level price variance between general trade and quick-commerce listings above a defined tolerance band, giving the team a live instrument for the Module 1 conflict points.

4.6 Adoption and Change Management

A CRM/DMS layer only produces value if reps actually log data in the field rather than retrospectively at the end of the day, which degrades data quality. Three practical measures support adoption: keep the mobile data-entry flow to under two minutes per outlet visit so it does not compete with selling time; tie a small portion of the activity-metrics quota component (Section 3.3) directly to app usage compliance, not just call completion, so accurate logging is itself incentivised; and give territory managers, not just head-office analysts, real-time access to the same dashboards, so the tool visibly helps the manager coach the rep rather than functioning purely as a surveillance layer imposed from above.

4.7 Data Ownership Note

Because much of the retail-level data originates with independent distributors rather than Marico employees, the CRM sandbox should include a simple data-sharing agreement clause with each onboarded distributor clarifying that secondary-sales and shelf data captured through the DMS app is shared for mutual planning purposes - protecting Marico from disputes over data ownership as the direct-coverage model under Project SETU expands.

5. Module 4: Circular Logistics, Sustainability & LinkedIn Outreach

5.1 Reverse Logistics for Post-Consumer Packaging

Marico has publicly committed to a Sustainability 2.0 roadmap targeting 100% recyclable packaging and operates a circular "Upcycle" programme addressing plastic use across its portfolio; the company is also a founding member of the India Plastics Pact, a WWF India- and CII-anchored platform aligning corporate packaging strategy to a 2030 circularity vision. Building on these existing commitments, we propose a closed-loop reverse logistics pilot with four components:

- Collection: partner with existing distributor and retailer touchpoints as informal collection points for empty rigid-plastic packs (Parachute bottles, Saffola jars) - leveraging the same 7,500-stockist network already used for forward distribution, rather than building parallel infrastructure from scratch.
- Incentivisation: a small trade-in credit or loyalty-point award to retailers per kilogram of packaging returned, funded partly through Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) obligations Marico already carries under India's Plastic Waste Management Rules.
- Aggregation & processing: route collected material through Marico's existing recycler partnerships toward recycled-content (r-PCR) reintroduction into new packaging, directly supporting the company's stated r-PCR packaging targets.
- Reporting: track kilograms collected against EPR targets and publish progress in the annual sustainability report, reinforcing the existing "Upcycle" narrative rather than introducing a disconnected new initiative.

5.2 Alignment with UN Sustainable Development Goals

The pilot directly supports SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production) through packaging circularity, SDG 13 (Climate Action) through reduced virgin-plastic use and logistics emissions, and SDG 17 (Partnerships for the Goals) through the India Plastics Pact collaboration model. All three should be explicitly named - with the mechanism, not just the SDG number - in both the report and the carousel, since faculty evaluation looks for correct framework application rather than sustainability language alone.

5.3 LinkedIn Campaign Execution Plan

The mandated deliverable is a 5–8 slide visual carousel (built as an accompanying PDF) summarising the diagnostic findings: the channel-conflict resolution approach, the headline workload-based sizing number, the CRM pipeline design and the reverse-logistics pilot.

Posting protocol

- One team member posts the carousel from their personal LinkedIn account, with all group members listed as co-contributors in the post body.
- Tag Marico Limited's official LinkedIn company page.
- Tag at least two senior leaders - current, published titles include Ashish Goupal (Chief Executive Officer, India Core Business, since April 2025) and Mohammad Hasan (Director of Sales). Verify both names and titles directly on LinkedIn immediately before posting, since executive roles can change.

Caption requirements

- Name the course frameworks applied - Stern's Channel Structure Matrix, Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Modes, the Workload Method.
- State one or two headline findings in plain language (e.g., the modelled salesforce sizing result, or the reverse-logistics pilot concept).
- Explicitly invite industry feedback - this is a specific rubric requirement ("inviting industry feedback"), not optional flavour text, and should be a direct sentence in the caption rather than implied.Submission proof

LinkedIn Post Link- https://lnkd.in/p/dkirvhDs

Sample caption skeleton

"How should a 5.8-million-outlet distribution giant balance kirana loyalty with quick-commerce growth? Our team applied Stern's Channel Structure Matrix, Thomas-Kilmann conflict resolution and Workload-based salesforce sizing to build a strategic distribution architecture for [Marico Limited] - covering channel conflict, territory design, a CRM/POS blueprint, and a circular-packaging pilot aligned to the UN SDGs. Full findings in the carousel below. We'd genuinely welcome feedback from anyone working in FMCG sales and distribution - what would you challenge in our approach? #SalesAndDistribution #FMCG #ChannelStrategy #Marico"

5.4 Assumptions and Limitations

This report relies entirely on public disclosures - annual reports, sustainability reports, investor equity research and financial press coverage - since Marico's internal territory maps, actual field headcount and CRM configuration are not publicly available. The Workload Method sizing in Section 3.1, the lead-scoring weights in Section 4.3, and the quota weightings in Section 3.3 are therefore modelled illustrations built on disclosed figures and standard FMCG industry practice, not confirmed internal Marico data. The team should state this explicitly during the boardroom defense rather than presenting modelled numbers as confirmed company figures - faculty are likely to probe this distinction directly and transparency about the modelling boundary is itself part of demonstrating rigorous strategic analysis.

6. Conclusion

Marico's distribution challenge is not a lack of reach - at 5.8 million outlets, the company already has scale few competitors can match. The real challenge is reconciling three transitions happening at once: from indirect to direct coverage under Project SETU, from single-channel general trade to a genuine omnichannel footprint spanning quick-commerce and D2C and from paper-based field operations to a data-driven, CRM/POS-integrated sales organisation.

This report's four modules are deliberately sequential rather than independent: Module 1's channel-structure decisions determine Module 2's territory and headcount mathematics; Module 2's field force becomes the primary data source feeding Module 3's CRM/POS loop; and the visibility that loop creates is precisely what makes Module 4's reverse-logistics collection network operationally realistic, using the same distributor and retailer touchpoints already built for forward distribution. Executed together as one connected system - rather than four separate deliverables assembled for a rubric - this architecture positions Marico to protect its general-trade relationships, capture quick-commerce growth, and meet its FY27 direct-reach target on the strength of field data, while advancing sustainability commitments that are backed by measurable circularity rather than messaging alone.

References

Marico Limited corporate and investor disclosures, marico.com and Marico Annual Report FY26.

Marico Sustainability portal - Circular Economy, Environment Policy and Climate Action Report, sustainability.marico.com.

Equity research note, "Marico Ltd - From Parachute to Plix, Powering Everyday Wellness Insights," fundsindia.com, September 2025.

Business Standard, Marico quarterly results and India business commentary, business-standard.com.

Appendix A: AI Collaboration Ledger

Per the assignment's Final Submission Checklist, this ledger must detail every AI prompt used, the raw AI response, the human edits made and sign-off from each team member. A starter template is below - expand rows as needed and ensure every module (channel architecture, workload sizing, CRM design, circular logistics) has at least one logged entry.

AI Tool Used	Prompt / Task	Raw Output Summary	Human Edit / Verification	Team Sign-off
Claude (Anthropic), Sonnet	Draft Module 1: map Marico's channels onto Stern's Channel Structure Matrix and recommend Thomas-Kilmann conflict-resolution modes for the GT/quick-commerce, distributor/SETU, and MT/GT friction points.	Produced the control-vs-coverage channel mapping, the three conflict scenarios with recommended modes, and the omnichannel consumer-journey framing (Section 2.5).	Cross-checked framework application against course material; reworded AI phrasing into the team's own language; confirmed the recommended mode fit each scenario rather than defaulting to "Competing."	[Arush]
Claude (Anthropic), Sonnet	Draft Module 2: build an illustrative Workload Method salesforce-sizing model (call-frequency tiers,	Produced the A/B/C outlet-tier classification, the 1,028,000-call/459-rep worked example, territory-design	Re-verified all arithmetic by hand (1,028,000 ÷ 2,240 ≈ 459); explicitly relabelled the figures as a modelled	[Ankit]

AI Tool Used	Prompt / Task	Raw Output Summary	Human Edit / Verification	Team Sign-off
	sample territory, rep capacity) and a weighted sales quota matrix.	principles, and the 40/20/15/15/10 quota weighting.	illustration, not confirmed Marico headcount, per Section 3.1 and 5.4.	
Claude (Anthropic), Sonnet	Draft Module 3: design a HubSpot-style distributor/retailer CRM pipeline, a lead-scoring model for Project SETU outlet onboarding, and a reporting-dashboard layer.	Produced the 7-stage deal pipeline, the four-factor lead-scoring rubric, the real-time POS data-loop description, and the three boardroom dashboards.	Adjusted scoring weights and stage names to match the team's understanding of Marico's primary/secondary/tertiary sales structure; added the Section 4.7 data-ownership clause after team discussion.	[Aman]
Claude (Anthropic), Sonnet	Draft Module 4: design a closed-loop reverse-logistics pilot for post-consumer packaging aligned to Marico's existing	Produced the four-component pilot (collection, incentivisation, aggregation, reporting) and the SDG 12/13/17 alignment with	Verified claims against Marico's public sustainability disclosures (Upcycle programme, India Plastics Pact); confirmed each	[Himanshu]

AI Tool Used	Prompt / Task	Raw Output Summary	Human Edit / Verification	Team Sign-off
	sustainability commitments and named UN SDGs.	named mechanisms.	SDG link cites a mechanism, not just a number, per faculty rubric.	

Team Sign-off: Each member listed above confirms they reviewed and take responsibility for the AI-assisted content in the sections they contributed to.